



MONTHLY UPDATE

ICT Industry: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

23 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BENIN · BOTSWANA · CAPE VERDE · COTE D'IVOIRE · DR CONGO · EGYPT ·
EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ESWATINI · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · LIBERIA · MAURITIUS · NIGER ·
NIGERIA · RWANDA · SOUTH AFRICA · TOGO · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The state electronics manufacturer was [accredited to install and maintain every payment terminal on national territory whatever its brand or origin](#), widening it from its own-brand devices, against 1.6m terminals produced. The accreditation's own date is not stated — only the report of it.

Angola

The month's technology events were financial and commercial rather than industrial. The state raised [Kz 300.3bn selling 15% of the incumbent operator](#), reported as about US\$329m, at 120.72% subscription with 16,571 of 17,549 orders filled and 11,264 new shareholders; settlement fell on 28 July, the day the same operator's network went down.

Benin

A domestic content-verification platform founded in 2025 was profiled on 27 July; it checks text, images, audio and video, including AI-generated content.

Botswana

The incumbent operator reported [profit before tax of P146.2m for the year to 31 March, down 45%, on revenue of P1.47bn, down 1.6%](#). The figures are company-reported, and the [prior year is given as P259m in the 2025 account against P266.6m in the 2026 one](#) — unreconciled.

Cape Verde

The technology park's second phase went to open international tender on 29 July 2026, for supply and installation of facilities equipment and training, procured by the special projects unit in the Ministry of Finance under an African Development Bank loan. [Bids close on 15 September 2026, with a bid security of EUR 25,000](#) and beneficial-ownership disclosure required of the successful bidder. The contract value is not published, so the tender fixes scope and timetable without sizing them.

Cote d'Ivoire

An electric ride-hailing fleet took delivery of 100 vehicles on 18 July.

DR Congo

Two regulators [agreed at a first working session to coordinate enforcement of local-content subcontracting, with scope stated beyond telecoms to electronic communications, digital services and electronic commerce](#). It is a meeting outcome rather than a text: no signed instrument, no inspection conducted and no reporting obligation established, and nothing records an enforcement action since.

Egypt

A group inaugurated its Middle East and Africa regional headquarters and first global generative-AI centre of excellence in New Cairo on 28 July, backed by a company-stated US\$100m with about 800 staff ([inauguration account](#)).

Equatorial Guinea

Salvador Nguema Funtam took over at GITGE with a new deputy, the outcome of the July selection process.

The consultancy AVANTE brought public institutions, banks and technology firms to the Hotel Anda China in Malabo on 22 July with the backing of the national development agency ANDGE. Panellists included the ministry's director-general for artificial intelligence, GITGE's technical director and BANGE's deputy head of digital and electronic banking.

The base's first record of a national e-commerce platform arrived on 14 August, when the economy ministry and [SelBa24 met to organise the country's first e-commerce and digital-payments seminar-workshop](#), to run simultaneously in Malabo and Bata between September and October and to train SMEs, traders and farmers to open and run free online stores on the platform. Nothing about SelBa24 itself — its ownership, merchant count, transaction volume or launch date — is stated.

Eswatini

Domestically, [Letshego Eswatini set out plans to expand digital banking to the unbanked](#) following the grant of a provisional banking licence.

Ethiopia

[The change of control over the second network operator's parent completed on 30 June](#), and the Ethiopian regulatory approval for it is not on the record. Separately an [Addis Ababa engineering services firm founded in 2021 was profiled](#), the base's only named domestic firm in this class.

Gabon

A ride-hailing platform [began recruiting drivers at Libreville in partnership with a local transport operator, without announcing a launch date, the cities it will serve, its tariffs or its regulatory framework](#). It works as a pure intermediary with no fleet or drivers of its own, entering a market where one competitor has operated since 2021 and electric taxis were deployed in late 2025 under a state-backed project.

Gambia

GAMTEL and YCELL [signed the Share Investment and Network Modernization Agreement on 9 July 2026](#), transferring an 80% equity stake in GAMCEL and committing GMD 6.1 billion to modernisation: nationwide 4G and 5G radio access, core upgrades, next-generation operations and billing systems, a new head office, hybrid tower power and revenue assurance. It closes a process the government [described to lawmakers in December 2025 as a D6.7 billion winning bid](#), about D800m of it a direct payment for the shares. The two figures are not reconciled in anything held.

Ghana

On 27 July a company filed a writ claiming authorship of the 2007 design of the dominant mobile-money platform; the operator answered on 31 July that the claims are without merit and it will contest fully.

Liberia

The port authority signed a [non-exclusive smart-ports memorandum with HAROPA PORT covering all four seaports, with no amount, date or named system](#).

Mauritius

The ICT minister [put information technology at about 5.4% of gross domestic product against an ambition of 10-12%](#). The two accounts name different third partners.

Niger

Hardware assembly is the one industrial position with a date attached. A government delegation inspecting the electronics plant at Hamdallaye [put it at 63 per cent complete and due in service by the end of October 2026, to assemble smartphones, computers and tablets](#). A completion percentage and a month are more than most rows in this report carry; what is absent is everything downstream of the building — capacity, cost, ownership and who buys the output.

Nigeria

[Mobile money revenue at the largest operator grew about 132% in the first half and active wallets rose 1.3 million to five million](#), while suspending a single airtime-lending product took second-quarter fintech revenue to ₦12.99bn, down 72.4% year on year — establishing that the book the market had read as a payments business was substantially an airtime-lending business.

Rwanda

The information and communication sector [employed 19,000 workers in the second quarter of 2026 against about 12,000 a year earlier](#) — up 62.6% against 2.7% economy-wide, and still about 0.4% of total employment, against a sector target of 50,000 digital jobs by 2029.

South Africa

The sector's transformation body lost its chair. The communications minister [replaced the B-BBEE ICT Sector Council's chairperson and appointed an interim chair for six months](#) on 14 August, after a departmental investigation found the council dysfunctional. The investigation report is not published, and no remedial plan, terms of reference for the interim period or date for a permanent appointment is stated.

The informal economy became a data product. A listed payments company [began selling near-real-time item-level intelligence on informal retail, drawn from a point-of-sale network of over 90,000 spaza shops and taverns and 10,500 checkouts, to consumer-goods brands, wholesalers and financiers](#). The network figures are the company's own, and no consent basis or data-protection assessment for reselling merchant transaction data is stated.

Platform transport worked the other end of the same problem — getting drivers inside a licensing regime rather than getting data out of them. An e-hailing operator [took its compliance programme to the provinces, holding a North West regulatory engagement in Rustenburg on 18 August attended by more than 150 operators and a Western Cape transport dialogue in Cape Town on 21 August at which the provincial mobility department's director of licensing and adjudication undertook to add e-hailing as a service option on the operating-licence application; the North West provincial regulatory entity put its pending operating-licence backlog at 3,000 to 5,000 applications](#). The account is the platform's own and the undertaking is not yet an amended form.

Togo

[Fuel marking and traceability began at Lome](#), the obligation having applied since 1 July: every litre through legal channels carries a molecular marker verifiable at depot, station and roadside, with sanctions running to seizure, fines of FCFA 50,000 to 10,000,000 and closure. Neither the contract amendment nor the marking regulation is held, and no contract value, duration or data-ownership term is published.

Zambia

The third edition of a continental diversity report puts [29% of Zambian startups sampled with at least one female co-founder, the highest of any country covered, and 22.6% with a female chief executive](#), against a continental 19.2% female co-founded from a sample of more than 3,000. The underlying report is not held; only the trade-press account is.

Zimbabwe

The infrastructure company reported [90 new base stations in the quarter to May and 17% of revenue reinvested into capital projects](#), on an undisclosed revenue base — so the ratio cannot be converted to a value.

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